

DISPOSABLE — Paper flipbook (PD30 bootstrap)

Purpose: Single entry point for **paper talk / chapter outline** work. Any new Agent thread: **read this file first**, then `transcripts/PD30_notes.md`.

Owner: Charles · COMPASS scaffolds · VECTOR rewrites prose later

Campaign plan (strategy): `PAPER_Campaign_Plan.md`

Figure inventory deck (red-pen): `_DISPOSABLE_paper_flipbook_PD30_FIGURE_INVENTORY.pptx` — full catalog · regen: `python scripts/build_flipbook_figure_deck.py`

Flipbook talk deck (Acts 0–VI): `_DISPOSABLE_paper_flipbook_PD30_FIGURE_DECK.pptx` — talk skeleton only (subset of inventory)

Charles → VECTOR checklist: `_DISPOSABLE_CHARLES_VECTOR_handoff_checklist.md` · COMPASS questionnaire draft: `../VECTOR_work/COMPASS_Dissertation_Core_Deck_Materials_Questionnaire_COMPASS_draft.md`

Alex mandate (PD29 + PD30): Question → figure → **1–2 sentence claim** per slide; **gap slides** for open holes; **end-of-semester** paper target.

PDF layout: slide-deck tables use default `pdf_styles_narrow.css` — **Claim** column fixed at ≥30% width (Acts 0–VI `# | Question | Claim | Fig | Paths` tables).

Say `anchor` in chat to paste the YOU ARE HERE block below.

YOU ARE HERE

Step	Task	Status
P0	Act 0 claims (§ Slide deck)	🟢 drafted — Charles red-pen
P0b	Act I claims (Army anchor)	🟢 drafted — Charles red-pen
P1	Act II claims (MBB replication)	🟢 drafted — Charles red-pen
P2	Act III claims (tenure cross-domain)	🟢 drafted — Charles red-pen
P4	Act IV claims (mechanism sketch)	🟢 drafted — Charles red-pen
P5	Act V claims (LOO pedagogy — optional)	🟢 drafted — Charles red-pen
P6	Act VI claims (limits + close)	🟢 drafted — Charles red-pen · G4 stub
P1	Tie each primary slide to reigning figure path	🟢 paths listed § Figure inventory
P2	Gap slides named (theory, causal ID, army CAC)	🟢 drafted in Act VI
P3	Export to PowerPoint / PDF talk deck	■
—	Campaign plan sequencing	✅ <code>PAPER_Campaign_Plan.md</code>
—	Big Fish scout pipeline	⏸ parked (PD30 back burner)
—	Tenure scrape / Big Fish poke	Background only

Time rule (PD30): Flipbook = **primary** intellectual work. Data = background unless a slide blocks on a missing PNG.

For agents — bootstrap instructions

1. **Read (in order)**: this file → `transcripts/PD30_notes.md` → `01_The_Problem_in_Plain_English.md` (first 2 sections) → `BINDING_Selection_is_its_own_step.md` (three separations table).
2. **Do not** re-litigate Big Fish data stories unless Charles asks for a specific PNG path or claim.
3. **Do not** open the 14-doc print stack or `obsolete/` unless Charles asks — see `00_READ_ME_FIRST.md`.
4. **Output shape**: Edit § Slide deck below — one row per slide: `# | Question | Claim | Fig (short) | Paths & notes`
5. **Voice**: Outline claims for Charles to approve; not VECTOR manuscript prose yet.
6. **Binding**: Environment (`L_net = B - D`) ≠ advancement. Advancement = **score** (`S_i`, λ) then **select** (top K). Hero curve = **Layer A outcomes**, not the mechanism by itself.

One-sentence thesis (doc 01)

Organizations advance some people and not others. Strong peers can **help** and **hurt**. The dissertation asks whether that tension appears in data — and whether **congestion in the score** that ranks candidates can produce hero-shaped curves.

Charles lock — narrative anchor (Sep 4, 2026)

Layer	Setting	Role
Scientific anchor	Army (HRC talent)	Strong inverted-U in promotion/survival vs unit pool quality — the phenomenon that started the project.
Working stand-in	NCAA MBB	Shifted here because we had the data while CAC access was unavailable — not because basketball is the deeper result.
Cross-domain leg	Tenure	Same skeleton, academic pond; PD29 locks.
When CAC returns	Army again	Re-center the flipbook and paper on army porches + Cox/CIF; MBB becomes replication leg, not lead.

Talk-track line: “Army showed the hero first; basketball let us keep building while the card was out; tenure tests portability.”

Big Fish domains remain backup portfolio only (PD30).

Alex lines to honor

Source	Quote / lock
PD29	“Organize the paper talk — big question, figure, one-to-two sentence conclusion.”
PD30	“The big one is what’s the story? ”
PD30	Primary trio: Army · MBB · Tenure — still on the table.
PD30	Big Fish = backup ; perf metric storyboard = screen fast , don’t sink weeks.
PD30	MBB “still worked” even if weaker — don’t discount.
PD30	Football usage LOO “very interesting” — optional congestion slide, not a fourth anchor leg.

Three settings (paper legs)

Order	Setting	Domain	Y (advancement)	Peer X (environment)	Narrative role
1	Army anchor	HRC talent	Promotion / survival	Unit LOO pool quality	Strong inverted-U — scientific origin; talent/ Cox/CIF; CAC to refresh
2	MBB replication	NCAA basketball	NBA draft	Team LOO pool quality	Working stand-in while CAC out; 3x3 + reigning deck in repo
3	Tenure cross	OpenAlex faculty	Tenured vs out (decision year)	Dept LOO at decision	Portability test; PD29 3x3 + perf story
Optional	Football usage	FBS → NFL	Teammate usage LOO	Congestion pedagogy only	
Backup	Legends, NELs, ...	varies	varies	PD30: do not lead	

Deck order today: MBB figures are ready; army leads story once CAC access restores canonical porch PNGs (G1).

Figure inventory (primary)

Paths relative to repo root. Talk tracks: sibling *_plot_highlights.md where noted.

Two decks — policy: Inventory = superset (all germane figures for the story). Flipbook talk deck = subset (Acts 0–VI slide order only). Every flipbook figure must appear in inventory; not vice versa. Build script enforces flipbook ⊆ inventory.

Deck	File	Role
Inventory (full catalog)	_DISPOSABLE_paper_flipbook_PD30_FIGURE_INVENTORY.pptx · HTML	Primary table below + MBB/tenure manifest panels + extended rows (MBB building blocks, army_sandbox extras) + Big Fish backup
Flipbook talk skeleton	_DISPOSABLE_paper_flipbook_PD30_FIGURE_DECK.pptx · HTML	One slide per flipbook slide ID (Acts 0–VI) — red-pen against § Slide deck claims

Regen both: python scripts/build_flipbook_figure_deck.py

Label	Use in talk	Path
Army hero porch (G1)	Lead phenomenon — inverted-U vs peer pool (LOO-style)	army_sandbox/ARMY_G1_pool_minus_mean_fwd_cif_b8.png · Cell 11 z_pool_minus_mean_snr_fwd
Army own-TB baseline	Own top-block share — monotone (pairs with hero)	army_sandbox/ARMY_own_tb_ratio_fwd_cif_b8.png · Cell 11 z_tb_ratio_fwd_snr
Army Cox / partial effects	Formal curvature check vs CIF bars	army_sandbox/ARMY_partial_effects_pool_minus_mean.png · Cell 12 + 12.6A
Army pipeline / talk track	502→512→520; Run 1 CS+CSS YG ~2002–2013	talent/documents/520_PIPELINE_COX_OVERVIEW.md · Presentation Interpretation Run1_Slides_5-20.md
MBB 3×3	Replication porch; panel 9 = reigning hero	sports_sandbox/data_story/MBB_DATA_STORY_reigning_3x3.png
MBB highlights	Talk track per panel	MBB_DATA_STORY_plot_highlights.md · mbb_reigning_3x3_manifest.json
Tenure 3×3	PD29 decision cohort porch	tenure_sandbox/data_story/TENURE_DATA_STORY_pd29_3x3.png
Tenure highlights	Panel 9 β ₂ ≈ −0.017 concave	TENURE_DATA_STORY_plot_highlights.md
Tenure perf p1–p2	Career rate · cum pubs · annum pubs; 10-bin sensitivity	TENURE_PERF_METRIC_STORY.png · _p2.png
Model one-slide	Assign → score → select; unified S _i	Model.pptx · Model.pdf
Pass A sim (λ knockout) G2	Talent-only vs congestion-in-score (generative)	pass_b/PASS_B_generative_lambda_knockout_side_by_side.png
Pass A empirical pair	Â monotone vs poolq LOO hero — not the sim slide	pass_a/PASS_A_side_by_side_q16_allt_min20_mg10_9_21_last_ps.png
Football usage twin + LOO	**T _j flat vs LOO steep** — optional Act V	FOOTBALL_usage_Tj_q16_ew16.png · usage LOO panel
Football perf deck	Six-metric screen (Act V optional)	FOOTBALL_PERF_METRIC_STORY.png
Binding doc	Score ≠ select slide	BINDING_Selection_is_its_own_step.md

Extended inventory (inventory deck only — not flipbook slides): MBB panel 4 draft-mass ECDF (band-picking for panels 7–8 — not naïve-vs-hero); panels 2, 3, 6, 7, 8; Pass A side-by-side empirical pair; optional army_sandbox/*.png from extract_army_figures_from_520_notebook.py --extras . Rows tagged Flipbook: Act ... in the PPTX when a path also appears in the talk skeleton.

Three-leg composite (slide 3.3): HER0s_and_PASSes/composites/THREE_LEG_HERO_composite.png — regen: python scripts/build_three_leg_hero_composite.py

Big Fish 3×3 decks (backup only): football_sandbox , Legends_sandbox — see HER0s_and_PASSes/_DISPOSABLE_big_fish_datasets_assessment.md .

Slide deck (claims — Charles red-pen)

Format: # · Question · Claim · Fig (short) · Paths & notes — Claim is the wide column; paths and regen commands live in the last column only.

Act 0 — Frame (2–4 slides)

#	Question	Claim	Fig	Paths & notes
0.1	What is the puzzle?	Scarce advancement meets strong peers : the same pond that develops you can also crowd you when slots are limited. We ask whether that tension shows up as a repeatable outcome pattern when we bin advancement on peer pond quality (leave-one-out), not on own talent alone.	text	[OK] Wang arc opener — phenomenon before mechanism
0.2	What is <i>not</i> the claim?	The hero porch is Layer A : who advanced vs peer environment on its own axis. It is not proof that peers caused development, and it is not the generative model — environment ($L_{net} = B - D$) $\neq$ advancement (score S_i then select top K).	BINDING	[OK] Develop Layer A later · BINDING_Selection_is_its_own_step.md
0.3	What is the hero?	In Army officer promotion , advancement rate vs unit pool quality (LOO) shows a strong inverted-U : rates rise through mid-quality ponds, then dip in the best peer contexts — the clearest instance of the hero shape. This is a stylized fact under fixed rules, not yet a causal peer-effects story.	G1 CIF	[OK] army_sandbox/ARMY_G1_pool_minus_mean_fwd_cif_b8.png
0.4	Why basketball in the repo deck?	Army came first scientifically ; we built out NCAA basketball because we had the data while CAC access was unavailable — not because basketball is the deeper result. MBB replicates the hero family; when CAC returns, the talk leads with Army again.	text	[OK] Honest access narrative for Alex

Act I — Phenomenon (Army anchor)

#	Question	Claim	Fig	Paths & notes
1.1	Who is in the pond?	U.S. Army officers in the HRC talent stack: time-to-event from Captain anchor through promotion to Major , attrition as a competing risk , on a time-varying OER / senior-rater pool panel (502→512→520). Reigning Run 1 slice: CS + CSS job codes, year groups ~ 2002–2013 . Scarce Y = promotion slot in a rank-ordered ladder; peer pond = officers sharing a senior-rater evaluation pool at each snapshot (median pool size ~19).	520 overview	[WHOA] Verify CS+CSS vs code · 520_PIPELINE_COX_OVERVIEW.md · 520_pipeline_cox_working.ipynb · N≈258k intervals; Cox subsample N≈15,338 (Run 1 Slide 8) · G5 CAC refresh
1.2	Talent alone?	Own performance does the obvious thing : forward top-block (TB) ratio within the senior-rater pool rises monotonically with final promotion CIF — lowest bins ~ 18–26% , top bin ~ 78% (N = 16,417). The hero is not “promotion ignores own record”; it is a second curve on the peer-relative pool axis.	Cell 11 own-TB	[OK] ARMY_own_tb_ratio_fwd_cif_b8.png · z_tb_ratio_fwd_snr · Run 1 Slide 6 in Presentation_Interpretation_Run1_Slides_5-20.md
1.3	The hero shape?	Peer pool quality (leave-self-out) : pool_minus_mean = each officer’s standing vs the senior-rater pool mean with self removed. Final promotion CIF by Q1–Q8 : low bottom bins (~0.22–0.29), rises middle, peaks upper-mid (Q5–Q7, ~0.62–0.71), falls top bin(s) — strongest inverted-U in the three-leg story. Stylized fact , not causal peer effects.	G1 hero	[OK] ARMY_G1_pool_minus_mean_fwd_cif_b8.png · Cell 11 z_pool_minus_mean_snr_fwd
1.4	Formal check?	Cox proportional hazards for promotion to Major (attrition competing): linear + squared pool-minus-mean terms significant ; negative squared coefficient matches concave / inverted-U CIF. Own TB ↔ pool-minus-mean $r \approx 0.93$ — CIF porch = headline, Cox = formal curvature check, not causal ID.	Cell 12 Cox	[WHOA] Verify population; add HR explainer · ARMY_partial_effects_pool_minus_mean.png · Pertinent_Thoughts.md · optional bwd sensitivity Run 1 Slide 11

Act II — Replication (MBB — data we had)

#	Question	Claim	Fig	Paths & notes
2.1	Who is in the pond?	NCAA men's basketball, 2009–2021, final college season: N = 22,795 last-ps rows, 615 ever drafted (~2.7%). Filters: min20 · mg10 · ALLT; peer axis = poolq_LOO. Replication cohort while CAC blocked army refresh.	MBB 3x3 p1	[OK] MBB_DATA_STORY_reigning_3x3.png · mbb_reigning_3x3_manifest.json
2.2	Talent alone? (naïve)	Naïve read: mean draft rate rises monotonically across own-ability ventiles (PPM z within season). Sets up 2.3: hero is a second curve on peer pool LOO, not “draft ignores talent.”	Naïve ability	[OK] pass_a/PASS_A_naive_ability_q16_allt_min20_mg10_9_21_1 · regen: pass_a_empirical_bundle.py --panel-rows last-ps --season-min 2009 --season-max 2021 --naive-panel
2.2b	(inventory) Draft-mass ECDF	Not naïve-vs-hero — shows where draft mass sits on Â. Motivates panels 7–8 (CCT / elite-pond band-picking).	ECDF p4	Inventory only · fhero/BDP_Ai_draft_mass_ecdf_.png · MBB_DATA_STORY_plot_highlights.md §4
2.3	Same axis, same family?	Pool LOO shows a different shape than own Â: draft rate rises through mid ponds, then flattens / softens in elite LOO bins ($\beta_2 \approx +0.002$ — weaker tail than army, same family). MBB replicates while army was scientific origin.	MBB HERO p9	[OK] hero/HERO_ew16_allt_min20_mg10_09_21_last_ps_perm_loo · tail dip sharper in panel 8 if Alex pushes
2.4	Assortment / overlap?	Teams are not isolated talent bins — roster windows overlap; team mean confounds self with peers. LOO defines environment without you — why hero uses teammate LOO, not raw T_j.	Overlap p5	[OK] REIGNING_team_interval_overlap_mg10_min20_09_21.png

Act III — Cross-domain (tenure)

#	Question	Claim	Fig	Paths & notes
3.1	Same skeleton, academia?	PD29 decision cohort (N = 391 resolved): tenure rate vs whole-dept LOO on career rate shows middle rise then concavity (Q16; $\beta_2 \approx -0.017$). Same pond + LOO + scarce Y skeleton — portability with sparse N.	Tenure HERO	[OK] HERO_tenure_q16_decision_dept_loo_infHM_slide.png · TENURE_DATA_STORY_pd29_3x3.png · n=389 with LOO
3.2	Which performance metric?	Alex lock: Â = career rate at decision year. Perf deck compares career rate · cum pubs · annum pubs — metric choice moves the porch; reigning track uses career rate.	Perf story	[OK] TENURE_PERF_METRIC_STORY.png · _p2.png (10-bin sensitivity)
3.3	Hit rate across three legs?	Same LOO logic, graded signal: Army strongest inverted-U; MBB middle rise, softer tail; Tenure concave, modest N. Pattern repeatable; magnitudes differ.	3-leg composite	[OK] composites/THREE_LEG_HERO_composite.png · regen: build_three_leg_hero_composite.py · future: Army-style axis standardization

Act IV — Mechanism sketch (minimal model)

#	Question	Claim	Fig	Paths & notes
4.0	What is the minimal model?	Four-step thought experiment: (1) assign to peer ponds; (2) score; (3) select top K; (4) visualize binned advancement. Acts I–III = Layer A outcomes; this block tests whether simple scoring can qualitatively compress elite bins.	text	[OK] Plain-English intro before Model slide
4.1	The four steps (detail)	Charles slide (Sep 2026): 1. Soft assignment → 2. Score $S_i = A_i + \lambda(B - D)$ → 3. Select top K → 4. Visualize. Includes empirical naïve vs hero on MBB. Minimal sim — not a claim real institutions use this formula.	Model slide	[OK] Model.pptx · Notation: slide $A + \lambda(B - D)$ = BINDING/sim $A - \lambda L_C$ (same score step; L_C toggled in λ knockout)
4.2	Congestion in the score? (sim)	Generative knockout: Left $S_i = A_i$ ($\lambda=0$) monotone; Right congestion in score — middle rise, elite compress. Qualitative POC — sim bins pool mean; data bins poolq LOO.	λ knockout G2	[OK] pass_b/PASS_B_generative_lambda_knockout_side_by_side. · regen: pass_b_generative_knockout_bundle.py · empirical pair: inventory 4.2b
4.3	Environment ≠ advancement?	$L_{net} = B - D$ is peer environment, not who wins the slot. Advancement = score then select. Hero = outcome; sim = one-ingredient check — not causal peer effects.	BINDING	[OK] BINDING_Selection_is_its_own_step.md

Act V — Pedagogy / LOO lesson (optional, 1–2 slides)

[All of this Act V is premature - we will evaluate other possible datasets betong talent, sports, and tenure later]

#	Question	Claim	Fig	Paths & notes
5.1	Why LOO, not team mean?	Team mean **T_j** → flat draft rate (~9% → 7%); usage LOO → steep (~16% → 4%). Congestion is peer-relative — who you share touches with.	Usage twin	▮ Act V parked · FOOTBALL_usage_Tj_q16_ew16.png · usage LOO panel · optional, not fourth leg
5.2	Wrong metric, wrong story?	PPA LOO (peer production) rises with draft rate; usage LOO (touch share) falls — same panel, flipped read. Motivates LOO on the right object.	FB perf rows 4–5	▮ parked · FOOTBALL_PERF_METRIC_STORY.png

#	Question	Claim	Fig	Paths & notes
6.1	Is this causal?	No — by design. Hero porches are Layer A stylized facts under fixed rules. Pass A sim is a qualitative check — not proof of causal peer effects, real S_i rules, or separation of sorting / unobservables (e.g. army $r \approx 0.93$ own-TB $\leftrightarrow$ pool-minus-mean).	text	[OK] Pair with slide 0.2
6.2	What’s still open?	Figures: G1 army CIF refresh (CAC); G2  λ knockout PNG. Science: F-HERO / θ -K-N; optional ρ ablation; tenure Cox (G3); metric sensitivity. Process: G5 CAC $\rightarrow$ army-forward deck; Big Fish parked.	gap register	[WHOA] Expand plain English · see § Gap slide register below
6.3	So what? (contribution)	Scarce advancement in nested peer ponds $\rightarrow$ repeatable pattern: advancement vs LOO pool quality often raises then softens at the elite tail (army strongest; MBB + tenure portable). We separate environment from advancement (score then select) and show a minimal sim where congestion in the ranking can bend curves. Contribution = phenomenon + mechanism sketch + portability , not one structural estimate.	text G4	[OK] VECTOR polish · Wang arc PD29/PD30

Gap slide register

Gap ID	Topic	Owner	Blocker
G1	Army canonical hero / CIF PNG (flipbook lead figure)	Charles / CODA	Pick from talent/ Cell 12; priority when CAC returns
G2	Pass A generative λ knockout PNG (pass_b/PASS_B_generative_lambda_knockout_side_by_side.png)	Charles / SCOUT	 Regen Sep 15 — pass_b_generative_knockout_bundle.py
G3	Tenure formal Cox slide (parallel army)	PEER	Post-scrape
G4	Contribution paragraph (Wang move)	VECTOR	After slide claims locked
G5	CAC (Common Access Card) / army data access	Charles	Admin

Canon pointers (do not duplicate — link)

Doc	Path
Re-entry index	00_READ_ME_FIRST.md
Problem plain English	01_The_Problem_in_Plain_English.md
Three kinds of model	02_Three_Kinds_of_Model.md
Pass A / Pass B	04_Pass_A_and_Pass_B_in_Plain_English.md
PD29 notes	../../transcripts/PD29_notes.md
PD30 notes	../../transcripts/PD30_notes.md
Charles checklist	CHARLES_CHECKLIST.md
Hero reset plan	../plans/20260721_hero_model_reset.plan.md
Paper campaign plan	PAPER_Campaign_Plan.md
Tenure campaign	HEROs_and_PASSes/tenure_sandbox/TENURE_HERO_Campaign_Plan.md
Big Fish assessment	HEROs_and_PASSes/_DISPOSABLE_big_fish_datasets_assessment.md

Parked (PD30 — not flipbook blockers)

- **HERO domain scout** (**scripts/hero_domain_scout.py**) — intake YAML $\rightarrow \beta_2$ screen $\rightarrow$ perf story on hits
- **Big Fish** deep dives (legends weak; football composite fail)
- **Education** porches (NELS, HSB) until story needs a fourth domain

Thread log

Date	Entry
2026-09-04	Bootstrap created post-PD30; slide table stub; figure inventory wired; agent bootstrap instructions.
2026-09-04	Charles lock: Army = scientific anchor (strong inverted-U); MBB = CAC-gap stand-in; re-center on army when CAC returns. Acts I–III reordered.
2026-09-06	Act 0 claims drafted (0.1–0.4) — pending Charles red-pen.
2026-09-15	Act II claims drafted (2.1–2.4) — MBB reigning lock wired to panel paths.
2026-09-15	Act III claims drafted (3.1–3.3) — tenure PD29 panel 9 + perf story + three-leg composite.
2026-09-15	Act IV claims drafted (4.1–4.3) — Model slide + Pass A λ knockout (pass_b CSVs; G2 PNG regen). Fixed Pass A vs Pass B labeling.
2026-09-15	Act I claims drafted (1.1–1.4) — Army 520 Cell 11 CIF porch + Cell 12 quadratic Cox; G1 PNG still open.
2026-09-15	Act V claims drafted (5.1–5.2) — football usage T_j vs LOO + PPA vs usage contrast (optional pedagogy).
2026-09-15	Act VI claims drafted (6.1–6.3) — causal limits, gap register close, G4 contribution stub. Slide table complete.
2026-09-15	Figure inventory deck + act-mapped deck — <code>build_flipbook_figure_deck.py</code> .
2026-09-15	Charles → VECTOR handoff checklist + COMPASS questionnaire draft prefilled.
2026-09-15	Charles red-pen pass: 2.2 → naïve ability panel; panel 4 → inventory; 3.3 composite; Act IV 4.0 intro; G2 PNG regen.
2026-09-15	Slide deck tables: <code># · Question · Claim · Fig · Paths & notes</code> — paths moved out of Figure column.
2026-09-15	PDF table layout: <code>pdf_styles_narrow.css</code> — Claim column ≥30% on all 5-column slide-deck tables.